

# Managing change

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Implementing innovation means changing things, and many people are resistant to change, especially in their working conditions. It is important to understand the reasons for this resistance, and manage changes to minimize user uncertainty.

## Understanding resistance

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Not everyone is against change—some view it positively, while others resist any change at all. This could be due to several factors: they do not see the need for change, they are scared it will require them to do things of which they do not feel capable, they are worried about losing their jobs, they fear they will lose control over their work, they do not see what is in it for them, or they feel overloaded with what they already have to do.

### **COMMUNICATE ACTIVELY**

**Communication should be active, open, and timely (before the change occurs), and above all, two-way in practice.**

## Getting people on board

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Change management is about understanding that uncertainty about change is natural, and dealing with the sources of that uncertainty. There are two types of resistance to change: the type you can tackle directly (by training people in new skills, for example), and the type that is emotional and maybe irrational. If someone feels their job is changing for the worse, that will shape the way they see the change, whether they are correct or not. You can address this only by creating a supportive climate where your employees can discuss and come to terms with their concerns.

### **BE SUPPORTIVE**

**Create an atmosphere in which individual concerns can be aired, and ideas within the organization used positively.**